# Check It Out Property Inspections

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## CONFIDENTIAL INSPECTION REPORT

PREPARED FOR:

## Zach Tieger

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## INSPECTION ADDRESS

1194 Highbluff Avenue, San Marcos, CA  92078

### INSPECTION DATE

5/6/2019  12:30 pm to 3:30 pm

### REPRESENTED BY:

Verner Dixon
HomeSmart Realty

**This report is the exclusive property of the Inspection Company and the client whose name appears herewith, and its use by any unauthorized persons is prohibited.**

# GENERAL INFORMATION

**Inspection Address:** 1194 Highbluff Avenue, San Marcos, CA 92078
**Inspection Date:** 5/6/2019 Time: 12:30 pm to 3:30 pm
**Weather:** Partly Cloudy - Temperature at time of inspection: 70-75 Degrees

**Inspected by:** Richard Zak

**Client Information:** Zach Tieger
(on file), ,

**Buyer's Agent:** HomeSmart Realty
Verner Dixon
Mobile: 858-847-5500
Email: HomesByDixon@gmail.com

**Structure Type:** Wood Frame
**Foundation Type:** Slab
**Furnished:** Yes
**Number of Stories:** Two

**Structure Style:** Townhouse

**Structure Orientation:** East

**Estimated Year Built:** 2004
**People on Site At Time of Inspection:** Buyer(s)
Buyer's Agent

**General Property Conditions**

**PLEASE NOTE:**

**This report is the exclusive property of Check It Out Property Inspections and the client whose name appears herewith, and its use by any unauthorized persons is strictly prohibited.**

**The client has contracted with Check It Out Property Inspections to perform a real estate inspection in accordance with the standards of practice established by the California Real Estate Inspection Association [CREIA] and is limited to the items specified herein. This written report will document any material defects discovered in the building's systems and components which, in the opinion of the inspector, are safety hazards, are not functioning properly, or appear to be at the end of their service lives.**

**It is the client's duty to read the entire written report when it is received and promptly contact the inspector with any questions or concerns regarding the inspection or this report. This written report shall be the final and exclusive findings of the inspector. Please acknowledge that the inspector is a generalist, and that further investigation of a reported condition by an appropriate specialist may provide additional information which can affect decisions in a real estate transaction. Our service and this report when utilized for a real estate purchase will often necessitate pursuing further evaluations of reported conditions. These evaluations should occur before removing any investigation contingencies and prior to the close of any real estate transaction. It is the client's duty to ensure that any material defects and the related components and/or systems noted in the report be evaluated or inspected and ultimately repaired as necessary by appropriately licensed or qualified contractors or specialists. Further investigations and inspections, and the obtaining of**

**written cost estimates for correcting defects or replacement of system or components, should take place before removing any investigation contingencies and prior to the close of the real estate transaction. Licensed and qualified specialists may well identify additional defects or recommend upgrades that could affect your valuation of the property.**

**This report is of a building inspection and not an environmental evaluation. Our inspection is not intended to detect, identify or disclose any health or environmental conditions regarding this building or property, including, but not limited to: the presence of asbestos, radon, lead, urea-formaldehyde, fungi, molds, mildew, PCBs, or other toxic, reactive, combustible, or corrosive contaminants, materials, or substances in the air, water, soil, or building materials. We are not liable for injury, health risks, or damage caused or contributed to by these conditions.**

**Photographs - During the physical inspection, the inspector will take digital photographs. The photos may be close-ups of specific components or devices, or wider angle images of a room or area. Not all photographs taken at the time of the inspection are necessarily used in the report, and all defects noted in the report may not be photographed. The photos are utilized in various ways; a visual aid in describing conditions and material defects within the report, as a note-taking tool for the inspector, and/or a record of the conditions of the property at the time of the inspection. Photographs included in the report are not meant as a substitute for written words.**

Report File: Tieger 050619-01

# SCOPE OF WORK

The real estate inspection performed for our client(s) is a survey and basic operation of the systems and components of the buildings in accordance with the Standards of Practice established by the California Real Estate Inspection Association [ CREIA ]. The Standards of Practice are included in the contract signed by the client(s) before completion of our inspection service. The inspector will meet and possibly exceed these minimum standards by surveying the basic operation of included systems and components which can be reached, entered, or viewed without difficulty, without moving obstructions, or requiring any action which may result in damage to the property or personal injury to the inspector. The purpose of the real estate inspection is to provide our client(s) with a written report containing information on the general condition of the building(s). Cosmetic and aesthetic conditions are not considered.

This written report will document any material defects discovered in the buildings' systems and components which, in the opinion of the inspector, are safety hazards, are not functioning properly, or appear to be at the end of their service lives. The observations and opinions expressed within this report are those of Check It Out Property Inspections and supercede any alleged verbal comments. It is the client's duty to read the entire written report when it is received and promptly call the inspector with any questions or concerns regarding the inspection or this written report. This written report shall be the final and exclusive findings of the inspector.

It is the client's duty to ensure that any material defects and the related components and/or systems noted in the report be evaluated or inspected and cost estimates for repair or replacement of defects or deficiencies be obtained. Any further evaluations recommended or advised and noted within the report shall be completed before removing inspection or investigation contingencies and prior to the close of any real estate transaction. Licensed and qualified specialists may well identify additional defects or recommend upgrades that could affect your valuation of the property. Repairs or replacement of defective or non-functional systems and components should performed as needed by appropriately licensed and qualified contractors or specialists

Narratives within the report are color-coded and separated into four types; "Informational", "Functional Components", "Recommendations", and "Safety Hazard or Needs Service". The categorization of narrative comments should not be the sole determining factor in making decisions for actions, lack of actions, further investigations, and/or repairs.

Narrative Color Legend: ¬ Informational v Safety Concern or Needs Service
m Functional q Recommendation

# Preface

## Site and Other Observations

**Furnished or Occupied Property Disclaimer**

*Informational Comment*

¬ Furnishings, belongings, appliances and/or devices prevented a complete inspection of all surfaces and the testing of all components in the residence and garage. The inspector makes the effort to determine the basic function of each system and test a sampling of components (i.e.; outlets, doors, windows, etc.) of the property. This may or may not include moving furnishings and items or belongings if it can be safely and easily done.

**HOA Property**

*Informational Comment*

¬ This inspection and report are on a townhouse or condominium type property. Some of the exterior systems and components relating to the subject property may be the responsibility of a Home Owner's Association (HOA), though this was not determined as part of our service. We will inspect or report on only those features which are directly attached to the unit, solely serving the unit, and are accessible for inspection. Systems and components such as the complete grading and drainage, whole building roof, foundation, and all exterior walls are not included. Hardscape, bridges, walkways and stairs, elevators, common parking structures, and all other exterior systems or components common to use by other owners or occupants and likely the responsibility of the HOA were not inspected.

*Recommendation*

q Obtain and read the associations' Covenants, Conditions and Restrictions (CC & R's) to determine areas of responsibility of the individual home owner. Request a history of the homeowners association's board of directors meeting minutes and obtain and read the HOA's Reserve Study to become informed of the association's budget including past and future maintenance plans for common area systems and components.

**Property Lines**

*Informational Comment*

¬ We do not identify, measure or mark property lines. A qualified land surveyor would be needed to determine the property lines.

**Pest Evaluation**

*Recommendation*

q Termite inspection is not part of our service. Seek an inspection of the property by a qualified state-licensed structural pest control contractor (AKA "Termite inspector"), within your inspection period and before the removal of inspection contingencies and close of any real estate transaction.

# Grounds

The inspection of exterior grounds includes the visible condition of site grading and drainage, and features directly adjacent to the structures such as driveways, walkways, and patios. Cracks in concrete hardscape can be caused by a number of conditions including, but not limited to, shrinkage, improper curing or mixture, expansive soils, settlement and ground movement. Determining the cause of the observed cracks and whether or not the cracks are structurally significant is beyond the expertise of the inspector and the scope of our inspection. Soil levels should be at least 6" below, and hardscape 4" below, the top of a structure's foundation. Exterior surfaces should slope away from structures to avoid foundation and wall damage. A functional rain gutter or roof drain system connected to a sub-surface drainage system should be in place to direct water away from a structure and its components. Subterranean drainage systems are not fully visible and this inspection does not include exhaustive testing of drains or using devices to see inside them. Silt, vegetation, and roots in drain systems can impede drainage and require repairs. The inspection of landscape components such as trees and shrubs is not included. Decorative or low-voltage lighting, and irrigation systems and equipment are excluded from the inspection.
Built-in features such as site walls, fences and gates, retaining walls, steps, decks, handrails and

guardrails, patio covers, and carports are evaluated unless noted. Low masonry or concrete curbs and landscaping borders are not included in the inspection. The inspection of landscape components such as trees, shrubs, fountains, ponds, statuary, etc. is not included although factors which may directly impact structures or the safety of inhabitants may be noted. Decorative or low-voltage lighting, and irrigation systems and equipment are excluded from the inspection.

## Grading and Drainage

**Site Topography and Drainage**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The property sits on a flat and more or less level pad. Drainage is facilitated by rain gutters, sub-surface drains, soil percolation, and hard surfaces.

**Site Drain Systems**

*Informational Comment*

¬ There is at least one sub-surface drain; at the rear patio. The termination of this drain was not verified or found. The site drainage system including common building roof gutters, downspouts and sub-surface drains may or may not the responsibility of the condominium home owners association (HOA). This was not determined as part of our inspection service. The seller and/or the HOA should provide information about the party responsible for exterior drainage, and information regarding the maintenance and care of any site drainage system(s).

**Surface Grade Observations**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The exterior grade is sloped away from the building and to drain overall, which is ideal.

**Interior-Exterior Elevations**

*Informational Comment*

¬ Interior floor elevations of the living space were above the levels of the exterior grade.

**Irrigation Sprinklers**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The irrigation system and any parts of the irrigation system or components were not tested or evaluated as part of our inspection service. We will note any observed adverse effects the irrigation or outdoor water features or systems may be having on structural components inspected.

## Hardscape

**Driveways**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The concrete driveway apron is in acceptable condition. The rest of the driveway is assumed to be the responsibility of the Home Owner's Association and the evaluation of the condition of the driveway is not included in this inspection.

**Walkways**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The concrete walkway and porch are in acceptable condition overall.

## Fences Gates and Walls

**Fencing and Gates**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The fence may or may not be the responsibility of the Home Owner's Association. Refer to the CC & R's.

**Site Walls**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The bench and yard walls are in serviceable condition.

# Structures

Structures are dependent on soil for support. Clay-based soils in particular can expand with the influx of water and move structures fracturing foundations and other hard surfaces. Some soils that might appear to be firm and solid can liquefy and become unstable during seismic activity. Foundations are not uniform, and those built with a permit would likely conform to the standards of the era in which they were built. While excellent at load bearing, wood framed structures are known to settle as conditions change and humidity levels fluctuate. Cracks in the wall finishes of interior and exterior surfaces are not uncommon. Cracks which may indicate movement beyond common settling will be noted if clearly visible. No engineering is performed as part of our service. Movement which may occur can be attributed to a variety of conditions such as soils-related settling of the building, moisture-induced expansive soils, seismic activity, and/or foundation or footing movement. Structures can move particularly if soil and/or if drainage deficiencies are present. Exterior walls should be capable of shedding water much the same as a roof. Exterior wall claddings should include a moisture barrier beneath. The presence and condition of any moisture barrier is not normally visible during our inspection. Holes or other openings in exterior walls and any damaged surfaces should be repaired to ensure that moisture is directed away from the wall structure. Water testing of windows and doors is not included in this inspection and we do not guarantee windows, doors, or walls to be free of leaks. In the absence of any major defects we may not advise you to consult with a foundation contractor, an engineer, or a geologist, but this should not deter you from seeking the opinion of any such expert.

## Structural Components

**Wall Structures**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The wall framing was mostly not exposed or visible. Portions exposed for observation were conventionally framed with wooden studs.

**Floor Structures**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The lower story floor structure consists of a post-tension concrete slab as evident by the builder's stamp on the garage floor.

**Ceiling Structures**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The lower story ceiling framing was not fully visible due to drywall and upper story floor covering, but is assumed to be standard joists or engineered joists. The upper story ceiling/roof structure is a factory built truss system.

## Foundations

**Slab Foundation**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The construction of slab foundations and building site preparation has varied historically over time and by region. Site and soil preparation, drainage methods, and concrete used all have generally improved over time. Footings sizes, seismic anchoring and reinforcing steel in concrete have increased in comparison to old foundations. Many slabs are found to have at least some thin, hairline cracks when the floor coverings are removed. Hairline cracks most often result from concrete shrinkage during initial curing. Larger cracks and displacement can be the result of various causes such as adverse soil conditions, poor site drainage and moisture-induced soils movements, seismic activity, tree roots, and/or plumbing leaks. There is no absolute standard for evaluating cracks. Cracks which are without significant vertical or horizontal displacement may not warrant repairs, however, a professional engineer would need to make that determination. Also, tolerances for variances in the level of slab floors is arguable. A professional engineer would need to make that determination. Displacement and cracks can worsen particularly if the site drainage and/or soils are deficient, and if roof and site run-off is directed toward the foundation and its supporting soils.

**Method of Evaluation**

*Informational Comment*

¬ We attempted to evaluate the slab foundation on the exterior by examining the slab's edges that project above the footings at the base of the house walls where visible. The residence is an attached structure and the slab foundation extends under adjoining units. Portions of the slab under adjoining residences are not viewed or inspected. The interior portion of the slab, also known as the slab floor, was covered with flooring and could not be directly observed at the time of the inspection. Aside from the obvious and accessible defects in the covered flooring, the condition of the interior slab is beyond the scope of our inspection.

**Observations - Slab Foundation**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The slab foundation had no visible or discernable major defects or abnormalities from our limited inspection. The house is believed to be anchor-bolted, however, the presence of seismic anchor bolts could not be verified due to wall sheathing and siding.

## Wall Claddings and Trim

**Identification of Wall Finish**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The exterior walls are finished with exterior plaster (stucco). Cracks in stucco are not uncommon and are usually cosmetic in nature. Cracks need only be repaired if they are wide open through to the moisture barrier. It is recommended not to paint stucco. A portland cement-based material such as stucco should be used for any repair including any refinishing or fog-coating of the color coat.

**Wall Finish Observations**

*Informational Comment*

¬ There are thin cracks in the exterior stucco walls running diagonally in meandering lines at some window and door openings at the rear of the building. Repairs not necessarily needed at this time. You may wish to seek the opinion of a qualified licensed plastering contractor for opinion as to whether action is recommended or not.

## Exterior Electrical

**Outlets**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The two exterior outlets are in good condition and appeared to be wired correctly and grounded. The outlets were not confirmed as GFCI protected: The actual function and/or presence of ground fault (GFCI) protection was not verified as electronics (TV) and stored items in the garage were blocking and occupying what is believed to be the GFCI control outlet. Once the house is vacated and before your final walk-through, verify that the exterior outlets are GFCI protected by tripping the test button of the garage GFCI and checking to make sure power is cut to the exterior outlets.

**Lights**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The exterior light at the rear door is functional.

*Informational Comment*

¬ We were not able to switch-activate the exterior lamp at the front porch. The light appeared to be common area lighting (serving both residences) and the responsibility of the HOA. It may be activated by photo-cell switch and/or timer and not lit in daylight.

# Doors and Windows

**Window Types**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The windows are aluminum or aluminum alloy-framed dual paned types.

**Window Observations**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The windows were serviceable overall where visible at the time of the inspection. Refer to comments below for specific defects, safety concerns, and/or recommendations.

*Needs Service or Safety Item*

v There is a window pane with a failed hermetic seal, as evident by fogging within the panes, at the guest bedroom (upper pane). Fogging or condensation within the space between the dual panes indicates that the hermetic seal has failed. Fogged windows should be replaced.

**Sliding Glass Doors**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The sliding glass door is a vinyl framed, dual paned type.

**Sliding Glass Door Observations**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The sliding glass door appeared to be in serviceable condition at the time of the inspection. The glazing was marked as tempered safety glass as required. Note; The glass panes are specked with some debris or material which may be difficult to remove. You may wish to have the door (and windows) cleaned.

**Exterior Door Observations**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The entry door is in good condition.

*Needs Service or Safety Item*

v The front door's handset hardware is worn; the striker pin does not fully retract when the handle is fully turned. The hardware is worn and needs repair or replacement.

Handset hardware is worn - not fully functional Replace or repair as necessary - *Continued*

*Recommendation*

q For security, change the lock(s) on the residence's key-operated exterior doors upon possession of the property.

**Screens**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The window screens and slider screen are older and weather-worn but are in serviceable condition.

# Roofs

Most roofs eventually leak and only the installers of the roof can credibly guarantee that a roof will not leak. Every roof will wear differently relative to the material type and quality of material and underlayment, age, installation, exposure to direct sunlight and weather, and the regularity of roof maintenance. Roof covering is only as good as the waterproof membrane beneath it, which is concealed and cannot be examined without removing the roof material. It is not possible to detect a leak except as it is occurring or by specific water tests. Water testing of roofs is beyond the scope of our inspection service. Water stains on ceilings or on the framing within attics can be old and will not necessarily confirm an active leak. We do not predict a roof's remaining life expectancy or guarantee that it will not leak. The seller or the occupants of a residence will generally have the most intimate knowledge of the roof and it's history. Any known defects should be disclosed by the seller. Roofs are inspected by walking their surfaces whenever possible, however, some roofing material types and roof conditions do not allow for direct access/walking due to risk of damage to materials or injury to the inspector. It is the policy of Check It Out Property Inspections and this inspector to access and view roofs of one story or over one story in height only if a level and solid staging surface not more than a single story above the staging surface is accessible. The inspector does not directly access roofs which require more than a single story assault. The method of inspection will be noted below.

## Concrete Tile Roof

**General Comments and Description**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The roof is a concrete tile roof. Concrete tile roofs are among the more expensive and durable of roofing materials. While warranted by some major US manufacturers to last for 40 years or more, concrete tile roofs are usually only guaranteed against leaks by the installer from 3 to 5 years. Concrete tile roofs are not designed to be waterproof, only water resistant, and are dependant on the integrity of the waterproof membrane (underlayment or "felt") and flashings beneath the tiles. A roof's underlayment/waterproof membrane will have a much shorter service life than the tiles. Many tile roofs fail when the underlayment

becomes brittle or deteriorated. The waterproof membrane and flashings cannot be fully seen without removing or lifting the tiles. The type and quality of membranes used can vary from one installer to another, and the use of flashings has historically varied in the roofing industry. Cracked roof tiles must be replaced, and displaced roof tiles fastened properly to protect the underlayment from sun and weather exposure. The majority of tile roof leaks result at roof penetrations, flashings, junctions, and roof valleys. Leaks also occur when a roof has not been installed correctly or when broken or loose tiles are not replaced. Concrete tile roofs should be maintained and kept clean of debris.

*Recommendation*

q The roof systems and its related components (such as rain gutters) may or may not be the responsibility of a homeowners association or property management organization. Request the homeowners association documents such as the Covenants, Conditions and Restrictions (CC&R's) from the seller to determine the party responsible for the roof system. Also, request a history of any roof leaks or deficiencies, roof repairs, and future roof maintenance plans.

**Method of Evaluation**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The first story roof portion (over the garage) was evaluated by walking the roof surfaces and by viewing from a ladder at the eaves. We were unable to access the second-story roof due to its height and evaluated it from the limited available vantage points on the ground and from standing on the first story roof, and by viewing from the underside within the attic where visible.

**Roofing Material**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The portions of the concrete tile roof we could see appeared to be in acceptable condition. No moisture stains were noted in the attic. This is not a guarantee against leaks. For a guarantee, you would need to have an established and qualified roofing company perform a water-test and issue a roof certification.

**Flashing**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The roof flashings at the vent pipe penetrations are in acceptable condition where visible. Metal primary flashings were noted.

**Gutters and Drainage**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The gutters at the garage roof edges were found to be in acceptable condition. Some portions of the gutters are level. Ideally the rain gutters would be a bit more pitched to direct water into the downspouts, but they should function as they were intended.

¬ The second story roof gutters appear to be in acceptable condition, as viewed from the ground. However, without inspecting the gutters from above and holding a level up to them, it is difficult to judge whether they are correctly pitched to direct water into the downspouts. They appear as though they should function as intended.

# Chimneys

The inspection of a chimney is important in order to detect problems within the venting system. The N.F.P.A. procedure defines three levels of inspection according to the circumstances that trigger the need for the inspection. A Level I Inspection is the most basic type of inspection and used to determine if the fireplace is suitable for usage, while Level II and Level III Inspections are progressively more detailed and thorough. Our inspection of chimneys is not an NFPA Level I, II, or III inspection.

Our inspection conforms to real estate inspection industry standards and is that of a generalist and not a specialist. Significant areas of chimney flues cannot be adequately viewed during a field inspection. As documented by the Chimney Safety Institute of America in 1992: "The inner reaches of a flue are relatively inaccessible, and it should not be expected that the distant oblique view from the top or bottom is adequate to fully document damage even with a strong light." Our inspection of chimneys is limited to those areas that can be viewed without dismantling any portion of a chimney or fireplace, and does not include the use of specialized equipment. Determining the adequacy of draft, lighting fires or performing smoke testing, or dismantling any portion or removing any component of the fireplace and chimney is not included in our

inspection.

## Living Room Fireplace

**Factory-Built - General Comments**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The living room fireplace and chimney is a factory-built, prefabricated metal type. There have been many makes and models of pre-fabricated metal chimneys constructed on building sites over the years. The manufacturers of factory-built or pre-fabricated fireplaces and metal chimneys always stipulated that their systems must be comprised of approved components and installed in strict accordance with the manufacture's installation instructions. We cannot guarantee that any particular component which may be present is one stipulated for use by the manufacturer. Metal lined fireboxes and chimney flue assemblies are normally framed in with wood and therefore must be constructed according to strict manufacturer's guidelines for clearances to combustible material. The areas of metal fireplace components adjacent to wood framing are not normally visible due to the architecture of common construction. The inspector may be unable to identify installation defects if present and concealed from view.

**Spark Arrestor and Weather Cap**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The chimney has a functional weather cap-spark arrestor.

**Crown or Termination Cover**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The metal chimney cover was not inspected or viewed at close range or from above as the roof was not accessed for reasons indicated above.

**Flue Chase and Fireblocking**

*Informational Comment*

¬ There is conventional horizontal metal fire blocking around the chimney flue in the attic.

**Chimney Flue**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The portions of the flue that are visible appear to be in acceptable condition.

**Fireplace**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The fireplace is in good condition where visible.

**Damper**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The damper is functional.

**Log Starter**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The gas line was capped therefore not tested.

**Glass Doors**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The fireplace glass doors are in good condition and operational. The doors should be in the fully open position or fully closed position during operation.

**Hearth Extension**

*Recommendation*

q The fireplace's pre-cast plaster hearth extension has chips in the finish, cosmetic damage. Consider re-finishing.

# Plumbing

Plumbing systems components include gas pipes, potable water pipes, drain-waste and vent pipes, shut-off valves, pressure regulators, pressure relief valves, and water-heating devices. Shut-off valves not intended for daily use are not tested or turned. The water pressure within pipes is commonly confused with water volume; high water volume is good but high water pressure is not. Whenever the utility-provided water pressure exceeds 80 pounds per square inch, a regulator is needed. Regulators typically come factory

preset at 60 psi. Leaks will occur in any system. Maintain an insurance policy to protect against loss and damage due to a plumbing leak. Waste and drainpipe materials range from modern plastic ABS [acrylonitrile butadiene styrene] pipes to older pies made of cast-iron, galvanized steel, or clay. The condition of drain pipes is usually related to their age. As significant portions of drainpipes are concealed, we can only infer their condition by observing the functional drainage at drains. Blockages can occur in the life of any system. We recommend having drain pipes video-scanned to verify their condition and also confirm that the system is connected to the public sewer system.

## Water Supply Pipes

**Hose Bibs**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The hose bibs include anti-siphon valves for backflow prevention.

*Needs Service or Safety Item*

v The hose bib/faucet at the rear patio leaks at the handle when operated and should be repaired or replaced.

**Water Main Locations**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The main water shut-off valve is located within the garage. The piping material at the valve is copper, the size of the water service piping is 1" reduced to approximately 5/8 - 3/4" diameter at the meter.

**Pressure Regulators**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m A pressure regulator is in place on the plumbing system and it appears to be functional. The water pressure at the time of the inspection was 65 - 70 psi.

**Copper Water Pipes**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The potable water pipes were copper tubing where observable. Most all portions of the water supply piping were within walls, ceilings and/or under insulation and not visible.

*Recommendation*

q Water supply piping whether copper or another type will eventually leak. Maintain an insurance policy to protect against loss and damage due to a water pipe, valve, supply line or hose, or fixture leak.

**Valves and Connectors**

*Recommendation*

q The water supply connectors and shut-off valves at toilets, the laundry, and under sinks are old. Corrosion and deterioration, typical given the age of the components, was noted. Leaking, inoperable valves, and/or obstructed water volumes may be experienced. Replacement of all old water supply valves and water supply connectors is recommended at this time.

Old water shut-off valves and water supply connectors should be replaced - *Continued*

**Functional Flow and Fixtures**

*Informational Comment*

- As of January 1, 2017, building standards/state law require that flow rates for fixtures in the home not exceed 1.6 gallons per flush (gpf) for toilets, 2.2 gallons per minute (gpm) for faucets, and 2.5 gallons per minute (gpm) for shower heads. It is beyond the scope of this normal property inspection to determine the flow rates of the plumbing fixtures in the home. Refer to seller for information about the manufacturer, purchase dates, and ratings of the fixtures present.
  The water flow rate for the bathroom and kitchen plumbing fixtures can fluctuate with the water pressure, is not evaluated as part of this property condition report, and is an unknown conditioned.
  It is recommended that the Seller be requested to disclose if the bathroom and kitchen sink faucets and bathroom showerheads meet or exceed the maximum gallons-per-minute flow rates allowed for bathroom sink faucets, kitchen sink faucets, bathroom showerheads, and bathroom toilets. If disclosure is not forthcoming, then it is recommended that a qualified and experienced C-36 Plumber Contractor determine the bathroom and kitchen plumbing fixture gallons-per-minute flow rates and if the bathroom showerhead flows more than 2.5 gpm then a 2.0 gpm showerhead is required, if the bathroom sink faucet flows more than 2.2 gpm then a 1.2 gpm bathroom faucet is required, and if the kitchen sink faucet flows more than 2.2 gpm then a 1.8 gpm kitchen faucet is required.

## Drain - Waste Pipes

**General Comments and Description**

*Informational Comment*

- We evaluate functional drainage of drain pipes by flushing every drain that has an active fixture while observing its draw and watching for blockages or slow draining. This is not a conclusive test and only a video-scan of the main line would confirm its actual routing and condition.

**Type of Material**

*Informational Comment*

- The visible portions of the drainpipes are an ABS (acrylonitrile butadiene styrene) plastic type.

**Drain Pipes Waste Pipes and Vent Pipes**

*Informational Comment*

- The drain-waste piping tested responded adequately to functional drainage tests overall. Refer to comments below and within the report for specific defects and/or recommendations.
- Drain-waste clean-outs were found at the garage floor. We do not use devices to view inside the pipes and the function of clean-outs is not verified as they were not opened or verified as service ready.

# Gas Components

**Gas Main and Shut-Off Locations**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The gas main shut-off is likely the responsibility of the Home Owners Association. The residence's gas meter and individual shut-off is at the meter set at the north side of the common building. Ensure that you have access.

**Gas Main Observations**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The gas lines were corrosion-proofed at grade level at the meter.

**Gas SupplyPipes**

*Informational Comment*

¬ Most of the visible portions of the gas pipes appear to be in acceptable condition. Refer to comments below and also to other sections of this report for specific information, recommendations and/or repairs needed to the fuel gas system, components or gas piping.

*Needs Service or Safety Item*

v Corrugated Stainless Steel Tubing (CSST) gas piping was noted as installed in one or more places: in the attic. Specific manufacturer requirements and state and local codes for the installation of yellow CCST type of gas piping must be met and most CSST can only be installed by manufacturer-certified installers. Equipotential bonding of CSST and other metal fuel gas piping is required for electrical safety due to lightning strikes and/or errant current to ground. Yellow CSST needs to be bonded (and black CSST needs to be installed according to the manufacturer to achieve bonding). No electrical bonding was found at the CSST unions we could see. When CSST is installed without being properly bonded to current standards, there is an increased risk for damage to the material from a nearby lightning strike possibly resulting in leaking gas which can cause an explosion and/or a fire. Manufacturers of CSST began implementing specific bonding requirements around 2006. A home with CSST present should be further evaluated and a certificate or final inspection from a qualified specialist (licensed plumber/certified CSST installer) should be obtained and placed on site.

# Water Heaters - Gas

**Gas Water Heater Comments**

*Informational Comment*

¬ Hot water is provided by a 40 gallon water heater located in the garage. Water heaters can be expected to last at least as long as their warranty periods but will generally last longer if maintained. Water heaters eventually leak so it is wise to have them installed over a drain pan plumbed to the exterior. Manufactures recommend flushing them annually to remove minerals (including calcium chloride, the bi-product of many water softening systems). Set water temperature at a minimum of 110 degrees Fahrenheit to kill microbes, and a maximum of 140 degrees to prevent scalding. For safety, water heaters are to be seismically secured, and equipped with a temperature/pressure relief valve and discharge pipe plumbed to the exterior.

*Recommendation*

q The water heater has been replaced or is not original. Obtain documentation that should include the necessary permit for water heater replacement. Confirm that the water heater and related components were installed by a licensed plumber or contractor and to current standards.

**Combustion Chambers**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The water heater's tank and burner (as visible through the portal) appeared to be in good condition at the time of the inspection. The inspector does not identify the exact age of water heaters, warranty periods, nor their life expectancy.

**Water Shut-Off Valve and Connectors**

*Informational Comment*

¬ There is a shut-off valve on the inlet water connector. The valve and water connectors appeared to be in good condition.

*Recommendation*

q It was noted that there was no insulation on the water connector pipes and heat or energy loss will occur. Heat is transferred from the water heater to both hot and cold supply pipes and we recommend adding insulation.

**Gas Shut-Off Valves and Connectors**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The gas control valve and its connector at the water heater appeared to be in good condition and the gas line includes a sediment trap as required.

**Vent Pipes and Caps**

*Needs Service or Safety Item*

v The vent pipe connector is disconnected and will not safely or effectively draft the bi-products of combustion to the exterior. This a carbon monoxide poisoning hazard as well as a fire hazard. The water heater vent system should be repaired by a licensed plumber or mechanical contractor. All vent system unions should

be secured with three screws per coupling, or mechanical means.

**Drip Pans and Pan Drain Pipes**
*Informational Comment*

¬ The water heater is equipped with a drip pan which would drain to the garage floor, designed to prevent extensive water damage from a leak.

**Seismic Straps**
*Informational Comment*

¬ The water heater is seismically secured.

**Combustion Vent Ports**
*Functional Component or Condition*

m The water heater has appropriate combustion-air vents.

## Fire Suppression Systems

**Fire Sprinklers**
*Informational Comment*

¬ The residence is equipped with fire sprinklers. We are not qualified to fully inspect, test, and/or certify fire sprinkler systems and we do not test fire sprinkler systems as part of our service. Obvious defects, obstruction or damage to sprinkler heads will be noted where visible. Fire sprinkler systems require service by qualified licensed (C-16 license) contractor.

¬ The fire sprinklers are believed to be the responsibility of a homeowners association or property management organization, as determined by a single riser noted at the south side of the building. Obtain the Covenants, Conditions and Restrictions (CC&R's) from the HOA to confirm the party responsible for the system and learn the policies for individual owners' responsibilities, and any HOA repairs and maintenance, and future testing of the system or maintenance plans.

# Electrical

A representative number of switches and outlets are tested. We do not perform load-calculations to determine if the supply meets the demand. In the interest of safety, we regard every electrical deficiency and recommended upgrade as a latent hazard that should be serviced as soon as possible. Electrical defects discovered may involve unseen components and would require the evaluation of the entire system by an electrician. Any recommendations made for service or upgrades should be completed before the removal of inspection contingencies and the close of escrow. A licensed electrician could reveal additional deficiencies or recommend upgrades. Outlets near wet locations should have ground fault (referred to as

GFCI or ground fault circuit interrupter) protection. This is a relatively inexpensive but essential safety feature and, generally speaking, have been required in many locations for more than thirty years.

## Main Panel

**Sizes and Locations**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The main electrical disconnect is likely at the meter and the responsibility of a home owner's association (HOA). The main panel, disconnect and meter were not opened or inspected - meter closet was locked.

## Sub Panels

**General Comments**

*Informational Comment*

¬ Sub-panels should not be concealed, blocked or otherwise be subject to impeded emergency access. Electrical sub-panels are required to be unobstructed and easily accessible for disconnect purposes and the individual circuits should be clearly labeled.

**Locations**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The sub-panel is located in the garage.

**Panel Covers Observations**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The sub-panel's cover is in acceptable condition.

**Sub Panel Observations**

*Informational Comment*

¬ There are no visible signs of damage or obvious wiring defects.

**Wiring Observations**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The wiring copper, a non-metallic sheathed cable, likely a common brand of modern vinyl conduit known as Romex.

**Circuit Breakers**

*Informational Comment*

¬ There are no visible signs of damage with the circuit breakers.

¬ The system includes an arc-fault circuit interrupter (AFCI) circuit breaker, for the bedrooms apparently. AFCI circuit breakers are now mandated by electrical safety standards to protect 15 and 20 amp branch circuits serving bedrooms from arc faults or in-line shorts. AFCI circuit breakers are not tested or tripped by the inspector.

**Grounding**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The grounding conductors within the sub-panel appear to be correctly wired.

*Needs Service or Safety Item*

v The grounding clamp is corroded at the main grounding conductor to the water pipe. The electrical service's grounding should be repaired by an electrician.

Clamp is corroded Repair needed - *Continued*

**Bonding - Copper water pipes and gas pipe**
*Recommendation*

q Bonding establishes conductivity and continuity (equipotential) between metal components such as pipes, appliances, etc. All above-ground metal piping must be bonded to the grounding target at the electrical service (the Grounding Electrode Conductor) to prevent a shock hazard in the event any of the metal pipes become energized. One of the electrical system's grounding electrodes is the house's copper water piping. The water pipes to/from the water heater include plastic or rubber bushings at their nipples, therefore, the continuity of the water piping as a grounding electrode can be nullified at the water heater. Also, the metal gas pipe could present a current differential from the copper pipes and be a hazard if one were to contact the pipes. A copper conductor (8 AWG copper wire attached with appropriate listed grounding/bonding clamps ) should "jump" the break in the water pipes by running from one water pipe to the other and also bond to the gas pipe. While this bond may not have been understood fully by trades-people or strictly enforced by jurisdictional inspectors in the past, bonding has come under more scrutiny and we advise upgrading.

# Heat A/C

The components of most heating and air-conditioning systems have a design-life ranging from 10 to 20 years, but can fail prematurely with poor maintenance or installation defects. Heating and air conditioning systems are activated when possible and evaluated in accordance with the CREIA and ASHI standards of practice. This means that we do not dismantle and inspect the concealed portions of heating and cooling equipment. We are not specialists and our evaluation of heating cooling system is not technically exhaustive. It is essential that any recommendations that we make for service or a second opinion be scheduled before the removal of inspection contingencies and the close of any real estate transaction. A licensed HVAC contractor could reveal additional defects or recommend further upgrades that may affect your evaluation of the property. Our inspection service does not include any form of warranty or guarantee.

## Gas Furnaces and AC Split Systems

**Limits of Inspection**
*Informational Comment*

¬ We do not remove and inspect a furnace's heat exchanger (firebox) as part of our service. The inspector will start and run heating and air conditioning systems if the weather is not too cold or too warm for either AC or Heat and the systems appear to be safe to operate. The inspector may make recommendations based on age of appliances, indications of metal fatigue or damage, or irregularities in burner or drafting

performance. The testing of refrigerant pressure, air flow across coils, and pressure testing ducts is not included as part of our service, nor is carbon monoxide testing included in our service.

**Description and Locations**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The furnace is a 50,000 BTU induced draft furnace located in the attic, and the air conditioning condensing unit is a 2.5 - 3 ton unit located at the rear patio left side.

**Standard Observations**

*Recommendation*

q The furnace and AC system is in the mid-range of its design life (normally 20 years). As part of a recommended maintenance service, have the AC evaporator coil cleaned, the circulating fan cleaned, return air and distribution air compartments cleaned if applicable and the filter(s) changed. It is also wise to have the heat exchanger dismantled and checked for metal fatigue or cracks. This service should be performed by a qualified licensed HVAC contractor as that specialist might discover deficiencies or recommend upgrades or service beyond that of our general survey of the equipment. The furnace and air conditioning system should be serviced annually and the filter(s) changed every two to three months of regular use. Also recommended is to keep a home insurance policy current to cover any equipment failures.

**Condensing Coils**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The condensing coil responded to call for cooling and was essentially functional.

**Condensing Coil Disconnects**

*Informational Comment*

¬ There is an electrical service disconnect present at the exterior coil.

**Furnaces**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The furnace responded to normal controls and was operational during our limited evaluation.

**Vent Pipes**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The vent pipe and cap appeared to be serviceable where visible.

**Gas Supplies**

*Informational Comment*

¬ There is a gas shut-off valve and flexible gas connector.

*Recommendation*

q The gas piping upstream of the furnace's control valve did not include a drip leg/sediment trap configuration in the gas piping. The absence of a sediment trap may allow impurities in the gas supply to block orifices in the valves and/or burners and may nullify a manufacturer's warranty. While most authorities having jurisdiction did not ask that sediment traps be installed in the era of this appliance's installation, the configuration may have been required by the manufacturer and is now required by building standards. In any case we recommend that a sediment trap be installed by a licensed mechanical or HVAC contractor to provide dependable operation and warranty coverage.

**Circulating Fans**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The circulating fan was not visible. The system's blower compartment was closed and the circulating fan was not visible without dismantling the blower compartment.

**Return-Air and Filters**

*Recommendation*

q The filter is dirty and should be changed at this time. Change the filter frequently depending on days or hours use of the heating and cooling system and more frequently if atmospheric conditions (smoke, dust, etc.) warrant.

Filter is dirty Change filter - *Continued*

**Combustion-Air**
*Informational Comment*
¬ The combustion air vents/attic vents appeared to be sufficient to support combustion.

**Refrigerant Lines and Evaporator Coils**
*Informational Comment*
¬ The refrigerant lines are in acceptable condition where visible. Note; we do not check refrigerant levels or pressure.

**Condensate Drain Systems**
*Informational Comment*
¬ The primary condensate drain pipe discharges at the master bathroom sink drain.
¬ The secondary condensate control is two shut-off devices. A secondary condensate drain or automatic shut-off device is a vital back up to the primary drain which commonly becomes blocked, particularly in an interior installation. The device was not tested or verified as functional.

**Drip Pans**
*Informational Comment*
¬ A drip pan was present under the AC evaporator in the attic and appeared to be installed correctly.

**Ducting Type(s)**
*Informational Comment*
¬ The ducts are a modern flexible ducting. Typical flexible ducting is comprised of an outer plastic sleeve and inner liner that sandwich fiberglass insulation.

**Ducting Observations**
*Informational Comment*
¬ The visible portions of the ducting appeared to be serviceable at the time of the inspection.

**Registers**
*Informational Comment*
¬ The registers are reasonably clean and functional.

**Differential Temperature Readings**
*Functional Component or Condition*
m The air-conditioning achieved a differential temperature split of 21 degrees (70/49) degrees, as measured from the point at the return air (intake) and the nearest register (output). A minimum temperature differential is debatable, and ambient temperatures, humidity levels and numerous other factors affect outputs.

**Thermostats**
*Functional Component or Condition*
m The thermostat is functional.

# Interiors

Our inspection of living space includes the visually accessible areas of walls, floors, cabinets and closets, and includes the testing of a representative number of windows and doors, switches and outlets, including the verification of a switched light source for habitable rooms. We do not evaluate window treatments, mechanical or otherwise. We do not move furniture, lift carpets or rugs, empty closets or cabinets, and we do not comment on cosmetic deficiencies. The inspector may use a surface contact type moisture meter at walls and ceilings if indications warrant such as staining, suspicious repairs, corrosion, unusual surface textures, dampness felt with hand, and/or potentially adverse moisture sources such as exterior grade and drainage deficiencies, plumbing, and/or roof deficiencies present. The inspector does not use the moisture meter in all cases and does not test each and every wall or ceiling surface. Our inspection is general in nature and not intended to be technically exhaustive, and is a random sampling of the conditions of systems and components. Also, we may not comment on the cracks that appear around windows and doors, or which follow the lines of framing members and seams of drywall and plasterboard. These cracks are a consequence of movement, such as wood shrinkage, settling, and/or seismic activity, and will often reappear if they are not correctly repaired. Such cracks can become the subject of disputes, and are therefore best evaluated by a specialist. There are a number of environmental pollutants, the identification of which is beyond the scope of our service. If you are concerned about the presence of any environmental pollutants, seek specific testing by a qualified environmental scientist.

## Floors Walls Ceilings

**Floor Covering Types**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The floor covering is carpet, wood*, tile, and vinyl.

¬ * The "wood" flooring is likely not solid wood and may not be wholly made of real wood - it appears to be a synthetic or engineered product. Some laminated and engineered flooring materials have been found to contain harmful levels of Formaldehyde. We do not test for Formaldehyde or other indoor air pollutants.

**Floor Covering Observations**

*Recommendation*

q Cosmetic damage to the wood-type flooring was noted. Scratches, scuffs and dents were noted. View for yourself to decide if repairs or re-flooring is needed.

q The wood-type flooring (in the living room/dining room) does not appear to be completely adhered to the slab floor; the flooring moves and pops or creaks when walked. Decide for yourself if this is acceptable. Consider seeking an evaluation of the condition from a qualified flooring contractor at this time. Repair

flooring if needed.

**Wall and Ceiling Covering Types**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The interior walls and ceilings are finished with drywall.

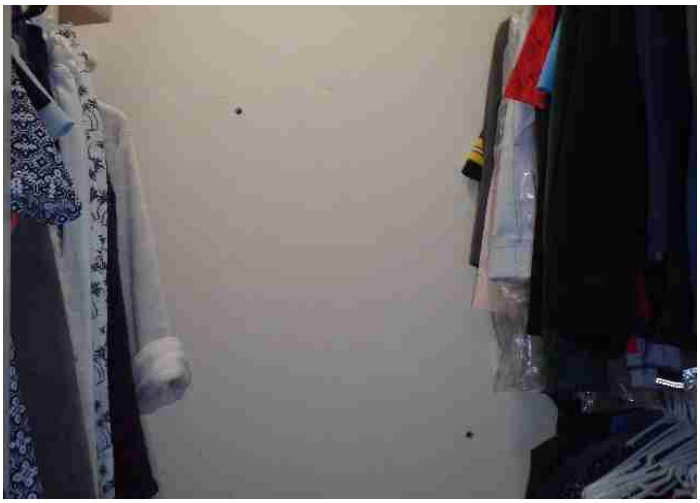
**Wall and Ceiling Observations**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The interior walls and ceilings appeared to be in serviceable condition overall. Refer to comments below or individual sections of the report for location-specific comments.

*Needs Service or Safety Item*

v Holes and dents in the walls of the master bedroom closet are in need of repair.



## Main Entries

**Lights**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The entry light is functional.

**Doors**

*Needs Service or Safety Item*

v The doorbell does not work and should be serviced or replaced as needed or desired.

## Living Rooms

**Lights**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The switched light sources are a ceiling fan and light and a switchable outlet - both functional.

## Dining Room

**Lights**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The lights are functional.

# Kitchens

We test kitchen appliances for their functionality, but do not evaluate them for their performance or settings or cycles. Appliances older than ten years may well exhibit decreased efficiency. We do not inspect free-standing appliances, like portable microwave ovens and refrigerators. We do not test microwave ovens for leakage as that would require a specialized instrument. Built-in refrigerators and trash-compactors are also not included in our inspection. Instant hot-water dispensers, water-purifiers, grills or rotisseries, timers, clocks, thermostats, and the self-cleaning capability of ovens are not evaluated. Concealed or countertop lighting is often installed after the initial construction, and cannot always be verified as wired to national electrical standards.

## Kitchen

**Dishwashers**

*Recommendation*

q The dishwasher is operational and appeared to progress through all of the cycles, however, the dishwasher's racks are a bit corroded and should be considered for replacement.

**Sinks & Faucets**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The sink and faucet are in good condition.

*Needs Service or Safety Item*

v The seam between the sink and the counter top needs to be cleaned and re-caulked or re-sealed to forestall moisture intrusion and bacteria build-up. Water drips through to the cabinet below.

**Valves and Connectors**

*Recommendation*

q Corrosion was noted at the supply valves and connectors under the sink (see "Plumbing"). While no active leaking was noted at the time of the inspection, corrosion is the precursor to a leaking or inoperable valve, and the valves may not function as intended when needed. Replacement of the supply valves and water connectors is recommended.

**Traps and Drains**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The trap and drain are functional.

**Food Waste Disposals**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The garbage disposal is functional.

**Countertops**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The countertops are in serviceable condition overall.

**Cabinets**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The cabinets are generally serviceable and do not have any significant damage.

*Recommendation*

q The cabinet doors and drawers lack pulls or knobs. Decide for yourself if installing pulls/handles are needed.

**Built-in Microwaves**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The built-in microwave is newer and functional; the machine heated water when tested. (we do not test microwaves for leakage).

**Exhaust Fans**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The exhaust fan is functional and vented to the exterior.

**Outlets**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The outlets at the sink counter are functional and include ground-fault circuit interrupter (GFCI) protection.

**Lights**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The ceiling lights and under cabinet lights are functional.

**Gas Range**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The gas range/gas oven is operational. The oven was tested on "bake" and "broil" modes (note; the oven was not calibrated or tested for performance).

*Needs Service or Safety Item*

v An anti-tip bracket is needed for safety. Anti-tip brackets secure a range to the floor or wall to prevent it from tipping if a child were to pull on or climb the range or a person leans on the door or otherwise causes the range to move.

**Refrigerators - Wine coolers**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The refrigerator and freezer were found to be operational and in good condition at the time of the inspection. Our inspection of refrigerators merely includes a visual look at doors, gaskets and shelves, and to feel by hand if the refrigerator and freezer are cold. This is in no way a technically exhaustive inspection and we do not guarantee if all features or functions of the appliance(s) are working, nor do we provide any estimate of remaining life of such appliances. Refrigerators/freezers are expensive. They need annual service (refer to the manufacturer). Pursue service records and any past maintenance information from the seller. Have the refrigerator inspected at this time by a qualified appliance technician.

# Bathrooms

In accordance with industry standards, we do not comment on common cosmetic deficiencies, and do not evaluate window treatments. Bathtub overflow drains are not water tested as part of our service. We do not leak-test shower pans unless a moisture stain indicates a leak test necessary. The possibility of moisture damage from errant leaking during the course of a normal inspection exists, though the inspector takes every precaution to protect property.

## Powder Room

**Description and Location**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The Powder Room is a half bathroom located off of the living room.

**Sinks and Faucets**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The pedestal sink and faucet are in good condition.

**Water Supply and Drain - Sinks**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The sink's valves, connectors, trap and drain were observed and found to be serviceable at the time of the inspection.

**Toilet & Bidet**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The toilet is operational and a low-flow type.

**Exhaust Fan**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The exhaust fan is functional.

*Recommendation*

q The lens over the light of the exhaust fan is yellowed from age and limits the light's ability to illuminate the room. Replace the lens.

**Outlets**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The sink outlet is functional and GFCI (ground-fault circuit interrupter) protected.

**Lights**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The bathroom light is functional.

**Floor and Walls**

*Needs Service or Safety Item*

v There small areas of moisture damage to the baseboard behind the sink, noted as dry to the surface at the time of the inspection. It is advised to have the baseboard repaired ad repainted.

Small areas of moisture damage - Dry at time of inspection Should be repaired - *Continued*

## Half Bathroom

**Toilet & Bidet**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The toilet is functional, and a low-flow type.

## Master Bathroom

**Description and Locations**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The master bathroom is a full bath, located adjacent to the master bedroom.

**Sinks and Faucets**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The sinks and faucets are serviceable.

**Water Supply and Drain - Sinks**

*Needs Service or Safety Item*

v The drain piping below the south sink is negatively pitched/not sloped to drain. The drain piping should be repaired by a qualified licensed plumber.

Uphill slope Repair needed - *Continued*

*Recommendation*

q Corrosion was noted at the supply valves and water supply connectors under the sinks (see "Plumbing"). Replacement of the supply valves and connectors is recommended.

**Sink Countertop and Cabinets**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The sink countertop and cabinet are in good condition.

*Recommendation*

q The cabinet's doors and drawers lack pulls or door handles. It is recommended to install pulls or handles for ease of operation.

**Tub-Shower**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The tub/shower is in good condition overall and functional.

*Informational Comment*

¬ Two small chips in the surface of the tub/shower were noted.

**Toilets & Bidets**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The toilet is functional, and a low-flow type.

**Exhaust Fans**

*Recommendation*

q The (two) exhaust fans are functional but noisy and may be near the end of their useful life. We recommend replacement at this time. The lenses over the lights of the exhaust fans are yellowed from age and therefore limit the lights' abilities to illuminate the room. The lenses or entire devices should be changed.

Noisy and lenses yellowed - At end of service lives - *Continued*

**Outlets**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The sink outlets are GFCI (ground-fault circuit interrupter) protected, but wiring defects exist (see "Electrical").

**Lights**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The bathroom recessed lights are functional.

## South Bathroom

**Description and Location**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The southwest bathroom is a full bathroom located upstairs at the guest bedroom.

**Sinks and Faucets**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The sink and faucet is serviceable at this time.

**Water Supply and Drain - Sinks**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The sink's valves, connectors, trap and drain were observed and found to be serviceable at the time of the inspection.

**Sink Countertop and Cabinets**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The bathroom sink countertop and cabinet are serviceable at this time.

*Recommendation*

q The cabinet doors and drawers lack pulls or knobs. Decide for yourself if installing pulls/handles are needed.

**Tub-Shower**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The tub/shower is functional.

**Toilet & Bidet**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The toilet is functional, and a low-flow type.

**Exhaust Fan**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The exhaust fan is functional.

*Recommendation*

q The lens over the light of the exhaust fan is yellowed from age and limits the light's ability to illuminate the room. Replace the lens.

**Outlets**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The sink outlet is functional and GFCI (ground-fault circuit interrupter) protected.

**Lights**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The bathroom light is functional.

# Hallways

Our evaluation of hallways includes identifying the presence or absence of safety items such as carbon monoxide devices and smoke alarms, and presence of proper lighting. Smoke and Carbon Monoxide alarms are not tested by pushing the test buttons or other means. The audible response from a device's test button may not guarantee actual performance in the event of a fire or carbon monoxide hazard. Replacement of older smoke alarms and carbon monoxide alarms is advised. Manufacturers rate the life span of a smoke detector at about 10 years or less. Refer to the device manufacturer's owners manual and replace as advised.

## Hallways

**Smoke and Carbon Monoxide Alarms**

*Informational Comment*

¬ Ionization type smoke alarms are present downstairs and in the bedrooms and bedroom hallway.

¬ Safety officials including fire departments and home inspectors in California and around the nation have been recommending that homeowners replace or at least supplement their common ionization smoke alarms with lesser-known photoelectric smoke alarms - and the state fire marshal may be about to officially endorse that recommendation. Ionization smoke alarms (marked with an "I" on the bottom) respond more slowly overall to dangerous smoldering fires than photoelectric smoke detectors and are more likely to give off false alarms. Photoelectric alarms (marked with a "P" on the bottom) use a beam of light to detect smoke and rarely produce false alarms. The inspector strongly recommends that photoelectric smoke alarms be installed in the residence. Smoke alarm manufacturers also advise supplementing their ionization type smoke alarms with photoelectric type devices. Upgrade for safety.

¬ A carbon monoxide (CO) detector was present in the bedroom hallway.

*Needs Service or Safety Item*

v A carbon monoxide alarm is not present as required downstairs. State law mandates a carbon monoxide device outside the immediate vicinity of each sleeping area and at each floor level.

**Lights**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The light is functional.

# Stairs

Our evaluation of stairs and steps involves particular attention to safety issues, such as the correct rise and run of the stair treads, handrails, and guardrails, and availability of switched lighting at stairs.

## Main Stairs

**Floor Treads & Risers**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The stair treads and risers have no significant defects.

**Handrails & Guardrails**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The stair handrails are serviceable.

**Lights**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The stairway lights are operable from both the top and bottom of the stairs.

*Needs Service or Safety Item*

v One ceiling light did not respond and should be serviced; bulb is likely burned out.

# Bedrooms

In accordance with the standards of practice our inspection of bedrooms includes the visually accessible areas of walls, floors, cabinets and closets. We test a representative number of windows and doors, and switches and outlets. We evaluate windows to ensure that they meet light and ventilation requirements and facilitate an emergency exit or egress. Window treatments are not inspected. We do not move furniture, lift carpets or rugs, empty closets or cabinets. Common cosmetic deficiencies may not be noted in the report.

## Bedrooms

**Bedrooms and Locations**

*Informational Comment*

¬ Two bedrooms were present.

**Lights**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The bedrooms included a switched outlet and a switched light for nighttime entry light sources.

*Recommendation*

q A switched outlet a an optional light source for the master bedroom was not verified, possibly due to furnishings. Ensure that the wall switch at the entry to the room operates an outlet.

# Laundries

We do not operate, test, inspect or evaluate clothes dryers and washing machines. The water supply valves and water connection are not turned on or off, and clothes washer drains and drainpipes are not flow tested. The water supply to washing machines is usually left on, and supply hoses can leak or burst under pressure. Therefore, we recommend replacing any rubber type hoses with newer braided stainless steel ones that are more dependable. Washing machines discharge a great volume of water, possibly more than older drain-waste systems can accommodate, which causes the waste-water to back up and overflow.

## Laundry Areas

**Laundry Location**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The laundry is located in the garage.

**Valves and Connectors**

*Informational Comment*

¬ The valves appeared to be in fair condition through a limited visual inspection. We do not turn or test the valves as they are not in daily use and typically become stiff or frozen and may leak if turned.

**Traps and Drain**
*Informational Comment*
¬ A laundry drain was present but was not flow tested. The presence of a proper trap was not confirmed as the plumbing was not visible.

**Gas Valve & Connector**
*Functional Component or Condition*
m The gas valve and connector are functional.

**240 Volt Receptacle**
*Informational Comment*
¬ No 240 volt outlet. A gas fueled dryer will be needed.

**Dryer Exhaust**
*Informational Comment*
¬ There is a provision to exhaust a dryer to the exterior as required.

# Attics

## Attic - Main

**Access Location & General Condition**
*Informational Comment*
¬ The attic can be accessed through a hatch in the master bedroom closet.
*Recommendation*
q The drywall attic access cover and adjacent ceiling are dirty, stained and chipped/cracked and should be considered for repair.

**Identification of Roof Structure**
*Informational Comment*
¬ The roof structure consists of a prefabricated truss system. Trusses are comprised of components called chords, webs, and struts that are connected by metal gussets machine-nailed in place. Each component of the truss is designed for a specific purpose, and cannot be removed or modified without compromising the integrity of the entire truss. The lowest component, called the chord and to which the ceiling is attached, can move by thermal expansion and contraction and cause creaking sounds, which are more pronounced with extreme temperature changes. Such movement has no structural significance, but can result in small cracks or divots in the drywall or plaster.

**Framing**
*Informational Comment*
¬ The ceiling/roof truss framing is in good condition where visible.
**Insulation Type**
*Informational Comment*
¬ The attic floor is insulated with fiberglass-type batt insulation, approximately 8" - 10" deep.
**Ventilation**
*Informational Comment*
¬ The attic ventilation appears to be adequate.

# Garages

It is not uncommon for moisture to penetrate garages because their slabs are on-grade. Evidence of this is typically apparent in the form of efflorescence, or salt crystal formations, that result when moisture penetrates the concrete slab or sidewalls. The columns and beams around vehicle doors should be made of structural components which include some structural enhancements such as post-straps and hold-downs, and plywood shear paneling. Evaluations of a structure would need to be made by a structural engineer. Note that garage door openings are not always standard. You may wish to measure the opening(s) to ensure that there is sufficient clearance to accommodate your vehicles.

## Dual-Car Garages

**Floor and Stem Walls**
*Informational Comment*
¬ Stored items and belongings prevented a full view of the slab floor and stem walls.
¬ The floor has cracks, less than 1/16" and with or no offsets. Such cracks are not uncommon when moisture at the garage floor is a problem. Cracks can result as a consequence of moisture, drainage deficiencies, and the presence of expansive soils. Cracks such as these are not usually structurally threatening, however, we are not qualified to evaluate cracks in concrete and you may wish to seek the opinion of a qualified engineer.
**Walls and Ceiling**
*Informational Comment*
¬ The walls and ceilings are drywall. The visible portions of the garage walls and ceiling are in good condition, though shelves and stored items and belongings prevented a view of the garage walls and ceiling.
¬ The walls and ceiling are sheathed with drywall.
*Recommendation*
q The ceiling has numerous spots of patching or repairs of the drywall. Ask the sellers for an explanation.
**Ventilation Ports**
*Functional Component or Condition*
m There are ventilation ports present and clear.
**Firewall Separation**
*Informational Comment*
¬ The firewall separating the garage from the residence is without holes where visible.
**Door to Living Space**
*Informational Comment*
¬ The house entry door appeared to be a fire-rated door and a self-closer was noted.
**Vehicle Doors and Hardware**
*Functional Component or Condition*
m The sectional garage doors and hardware are functional.
**Automatic Opener and Reverse**
*Needs Service or Safety Item*
v The garage door openers are functional but the doors do not auto-reverse with applied resistance. Adjustment of the downward force of both doors is needed.

**Lights**

*Functional Component or Condition*

m The lights in the garage are functional.

**Outlets**

*Informational Comment*

¬ One outlet includes ground-fault circuit interrupter protection.

# AFFILIATIONS AND CERTIFICATIONS

Richard Zak, MCI, ACI

Master CREIA (California Real Estate Inspection Association) Inspector

ASHI (American Society of Home Inspectors) Certified Inspector

# REPORT CONCLUSION

1194 Highbluff Avenue, San Marcos, CA 92078

Thank you for hiring us to evaluate your property, whether a home purchase, investment property, or for pre-sale purposes. In addition to any safety recommendations made in the report we ask you to follow these general safety recommendations: install Photoelectric smoke alarms and carbon monoxide detectors in locations stipulated by the device manufacturers and applicable law; identify all emergency escape routs and rehearse an emergency evacuation of the home; test GFCI (ground-fault circuit interrupter) outlets at least once per year; regulate the temperature of water heaters to prevent scalding; insure that substances containing caustic or poisonous compounds such as bleach, drain cleaners, and nail polish removers be stored where small children cannot reach them; check garage door safety devices regularly, particularly if they are the heavy wooden type; and install child-safe barriers and alarms on the exterior doors of all pool and spa properties.

We have made every effort to provide you with an accurate assessment of the general condition of the property and its components and to alert you to any significant defects or adverse conditions. We may not have tested every outlet or opened every window and door, or identified every minor defect. Also, because we are not specialists and our inspection is essentially visual, latent defects could exist. Please do not regard our inspection as conferring a guarantee or warranty. It does not. It is simply a report on the general condition of a particular property at a given point in time. As a homeowner, you should expect problems to occur. Roofs will leak, drain lines will become blocked, and components and systems will fail without warning. For these reasons, you should take into consideration the age of the house and its components and keep a comprehensive insurance policy current. If you have been provided with a home protection policy, read it carefully. Such policies may only cover insignificant costs and insurance companies may deny coverage on the grounds that a given condition was preexisting, or not covered because of building standards violation or a manufacture's defect.

Please take the time to read this entire report, and call us if you have any questions or observations whatsoever. A residential dwelling and its components are complicated, and because of this and the limitations of our visit, we offer consultation and encourage questions. Candid and forthright communication between all parties is vital in avoiding disputes and costly litigation. We orally summarize our findings on site whenever possible, however, it is essential that you read all of the written report.

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ATTACHMENTS